

About me

I've been developing software professionally for more than 18 years.

Experience taught me that techniques are more valuable than specific frameworks and that simple solutions are invaluable.

I like the whole software lifecycle and the lessons that can be learned.

Proud husband and father of 2 daughters.

Skills

Test-driven development

Clean architecture (CA)

Domain-driven design

Event-driven architecture

Automation (CI/CD)

Coaching

Containers & orchestration

Kubernetes

AI-driven development

AI agent development

Java, Kotlin, JavaScript, Groovy, Bash, ...

Dutch, English

Kris Hofmans

Architect, Technical Coach

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Experience

Conundra / PTV Logistics

Architect — 2021 - Present

Route optimisation software for logistics, used by large retail customers whose plans often contain more than 20,000 orders. These customers have no manual fallback, so operational stability was crucial: hiccups have a direct impact in the real world and failure or downtime was not an option. Resilience was achieved through decoupling with event-driven architecture and clearly defined failure boundaries.

Led the design and continual follow-up of public APIs around logistics planning, in close discussion with the customers using them. Also set up new infrastructure and further modelled the existing application using domain-driven design (DDD).

Architected MIRA, a logistics-focused AI agent built on top of AWS Bedrock, giving customers a new way of modelling and simulating logistical problems using an LLM.

Alongside this, improved technical practices:

- Practices: TDD and testing on multiple layers, working towards full continuous deployment for all components
- Ownership: all components run by the teams following the "you build it, you run it" philosophy, in collaboration with about 30 developers
- Scale: after the acquisition by PTV, coordination across the whole organisation to align ways of working and technology

TriNetX

Solutions Architect, Technical Coach — 2017 - 2020

Platform that makes real-world medical data from hospitals more insightful, both for the hospitals themselves and for global consumers such as the FDA and pharmaceutical companies. With recent, up-to-date patient data from around the globe, even rare cases can be matched and queried.

Also worked on making medical studies less error-prone and more efficient through automation and deeper integration with hospital systems, building on the same data ingestion experience from the data platform. During COVID the platform boomed, immediately bringing value and insights from actual hospital data to support decisions.

Introduced better technical practices to improve quality, decrease regression & bugs and increase rate of delivery.

Wide scope of introductions and improvements:

- Software development: Git, CA, DDD, TDD, clean code, code review practices, pairing, Kanban, event storming
- Better software delivery: config management, secret management, Kubernetes migration (zero downtime deploys), infrastructure as code, automation.

Community

Organising SoCraTes Belgium meetups since 2017, bringing together software developers, testers and other people involved or interested in software development.

Organising the yearly SoCraTes BE unconference, a 4-day retreat for about 50-70 people that combines the meetup spirit with interesting and entertaining evening programmes.

socratesbe.org

References

Jan Hanselaer - VP of Engineering @ PTV Logistics

Phone number available on request

Mathias Claus - Delivery Manager @ PTV Logistics

Phone number available on request

Joran Huysmans - Practice Lead Business Consulting @ PTV Logistics

Phone number available on request

Cara Calkins - Product Owner @ PTV Logistics

Phone number available on request

Jelle Victoor - CTO @ Conundra

Phone number available on request

David Voets - Engineering Director

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James Depoorter - Enterprise Architect @ Argenta

Phone number available on request

Founded Triple D (2017): trainings, workshops, software craftsmanship

Bringing together experienced software developers to work and learn together.

ACA Software Factory for Isabel

Tech Lead — 2016 - 2017

Software factory model for their Isabel customer, a new banking platform.

Modular software development using OSGi and Kafka.

Johnson & Johnson GTSC

Technical Architect — 2015 - 2016

Greenfield rewrite of a foreign currency exchange application. Due to the high volume & big financial impact we adopted a zero defect policy and strict TDD practices next to applying CA and DDD.

Argenta

Squad Lead — 2014 - 2015

Rewrite of several applications in the mortgage and loan domain. Ranging from credit simulations to workflows concerning mortgage flows including payments & external parties like notaries.

Eurid

Architect — 2013 - 2014

Rewrite of the DNS application handling the TLD for '.EU'. Major concern was performance because of high throughput rates and remote API integrations.

Johnson & Johnson GTSC

Senior Developer — 2010 - 2013

Update technical components in legacy applications and greenfield development and developing in-house frameworks.

BICS (Belgacom International Carrier Services)

2009 - 2010

Kind & Gezin

2008